As a result, newspaper editors agreed to accept materials originating in Iraq, even if they smelled of psychological warfare by Saddam Hussein's regime.

In the Israeli debate over freedom of the press versus the preservation of the security of the state, those who prioritize the former use the United States as their standard. They advocate the adoption of the American model of freedom of the press and the public's right to know. The military censor has become an archaic institution, and the Israel of the twenty-first century is expected to resemble other enlightened nations. I would like to state for the record that the public norm in the United States on this issue is interpreted in Israel in a distorted, or at least inaccurate, manner.

Totalitarian states favor state security over freedom of speech, although they sometimes use the excuse of security as a cover-up to conceal failures. Should the equation in democratic countries be automatically reversed? Every nation strives for security as an existential instinct, regardless of any ideology. It may, of course, be argued that the principle of freedom of speech contributes to national security in some respects. But it is impossible to refute the claim that absolute freedom of speech, without limits, is liable to harm state security. Sir William Stephenson, who was the liaison between the intelligence services of Britain and the United States during World War II, wrote in his book *A Man Called Intrepid:*

> The weapons of secrecy have no place in an ideal world. But we live in a world of undeclared hostilities in which such weapons are constantly used against us and could, unless countered, leave us unprepared again, this time for an onslaught of magnitude that staggers the imagination. And while it may seem unnecessary to stress so obvious a point, the weapons of secrecy are rendered ineffective if we remove the secrecy. One of the conditions of democracy is freedom of information. It would be infinitely preferable to know exactly how our intelligence agencies function, and why, and where. But this information, once made public, disarms us. So there is the conundrum: How can we wield the weapons of secrecy without damage to ourselves? How can we preserve secrecy without endangering constitutional law and individual guarantees of freedom?

In my humble opinion, security as a value should take precedence over freedom of speech. Even so, a healthy society must recognize the constant tension between the needs of national security and freedom of speech. A healthy society must accept the existence of these two principles and give each of them the appropriate weight. The United States, in this respect, is a healthy society.

In Israel, the military censor continues to function, though as a shadow of its former self. This institution has not been dismantled because in Israel no alternatives have yet been established whose role is to balance this